

9.3 Drawing Polygons And Curves

For when you need a shape that's not available, PowerPoint allows you to draw freeform shapes. Select **AutoShapes > Lines**. Under this menu, you are presented with two options: Freeform, which allows you to create shapes that include straight as well as curved lines, and Scribble, with which you can create smooth curves, making it look like the shape was hand-drawn.

In Freeform mode, click and drag the mouse to make a line—just as you would with a pen. To draw a straight line, however, you click and release, move your mouse to where you want your line to end, and then click again—and you'll have a straight line.

A shape can be open-ended, like a squiggly line that straightens in the end, or close-ended, like an ellipse. To keep your shape open-ended, just double-click over it. To close it, click near the starting point.

When you draw Freeform or Scribble shapes, you will notice small dots appear on the lines as you keep drawing. These are known as “Edit Points.” You can use these to modify your shape in order to make it look smoother by selecting **Draw > Edit Points**. If you want to add more Edit Points to a particular area on the shape, just click over the relevant place and drag it to insert a point. To remove it, keep [Ctrl] pressed while clicking on the Edit Point.



Zooming into the slide allows greater control over the shape you're drawing